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September 28, 2024

Diversity Recruitment  
American Express  
200 Vesey Street,  
New York City, NY 10285-3106

Dear American Express Recruiting Team:

I write to express my deep interest in the Finance Sophomore Internship at American Express, which I learned about from one of your previous interns. American Express's culture of innovation, learning, and purpose-driven collaboration appeals strongly to me, as an aspiring tech start-up founder. I am passionate about serving within the financial services industry as it will give me in-depth knowledge on big financial transactions. After speaking with Gavriela Meyers, an intern in your 2023 sophomore finance internship program, I was compelled by American Express' community-centeredness and efforts to give back to all members in their ecosystem - customers, colleagues and community. I know that the inclusive and people-centred environment in American Express is the best place for me to gain this financial knowledge. My strong work ethic, vibrant interpersonal skills, and demonstrated interest in financial services

Relevant to the position, in the spring of 2023 I worked as the Director-General of the African Leadership Academy's International Model African Union. I managed over 2 million rand in investments into the conference, pitched to 3 major investors including bloomberg, and managed the budget for over 250 guests at 5 international conference events, including the opening ceremony, closing ceremony, gala dinner, and diplomatic roundtable. As a result, I drove growth for our conference budget and increased our profit margins, allowing for 3 delegates were fully-funded to attend the conference, including flights, meals and board. I learned consistency and determination, as I had to face the many difficult challenges we faced along the way. Juggling being a student simultaneously taught me to be self-motivated, hard-working, and helped me find creative ways to be as efficient as possible in my position.

Additionally, I was in charge of managing the administration, finance, and media teams behind the conference; overseeing the distribution of our budget to our 30+ student staff team. I provided timely feedback and performance evaluations, spearheaded many team-building activities to develop and strong and motivated team. In my current position as a Community Advisor for Wesleyan's Office of Residential Life, I have had the opportunity to begin building deep relationships with my residents, developing the trust they can use to see me as a resource to ameliorate their on-campus experience. From this experience, and my experience being a Hospitality Manager at my previous school's student-led Church, I have learned discretion and confidentiality in work, which is so essential to building trust-based relationships.

I am confident that my skills and experience will enable me to be a valuable addition to the American Express Sophomore Internship Program, and I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my qualifications in an interview. You can reach me at nivie@wesleyan.edu or by phone at 667/415-5712. Thank you in advance for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,  
Naomi Ivie

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As I had to work

- Ability to initiate and drive change management processes
- Strategic thought leadership skills and creativity
- Financial and analytical skills with an eye towards developing recommendations to drive growth for our businesses
- A strong work-ethic and robust interpersonal skills, showcasing the ability to build trust-based relationships within the Finance team and with business partners across locations / geographies
- Ability to learn our business model and its key financial drivers
- Programming skills a plus

and pitch in high stress situations - when the impact of our program reaching those without the financial means to access our conference depended on our pitches.

Ultimately, we surpassed these OKRs: we set up online applications and emailed over 200 schools to invite their students. We also publicized our conference on Instagram and facebook, gaining over 600 new Instagram subscribers and increased engagement on our platforms than previous years. We additionally pitched to 15 supporting organizations and for the first time supported 30 delegates without financial means with the full cost to attend the conference. I learned polite and diplomatic professional communication, as I delivered feedback to my classmates on their work toward the conference. Additionally, I arranged the programme and selected the performers, vendors, and decorations for our cultural and formal galas as well as diplomatic roundtable event. I further coordinated the entry, seating and exit of the 300 guests for each event, guiding a team of 12 ushers. These experiences gave me an understanding of the inner workings of project execution, both logistically and with interpersonal engagement.

I am very passionate about the educational and professional development of young people, and the Gordon Career Center's work in developing Wesleyan students professionally aligns perfectly with my interests and passions.

We are looking for sophomore candidates with a strong-work ethic, *intellectual curiosity*, ability to build relations and an interest in financial services t

After speaking with George Yardley, a current member of your Student Staff team, I was compelled by the center's efforts to provide equitable access to opportunities to all students, regardless of their socioeconomic background. I would love to extend the same to students like me. My administrative experience, creativity and experience working in a team will contribute to my success as a Project Assistant.

Relevant to the position, this past spring I worked as the Director-General of the African Leadership Academy's International Model African Union. I was in charge of managing the administration, finance, and media teams behind the conference; setting our OKRs and directing them to completion. Ultimately, we surpassed these OKRs: we set up online applications and emailed over 200 schools to invite their students. We also publicized our conference on Instagram and facebook, gaining over 600 new Instagram subscribers and increased engagement on our platforms than previous years. We additionally pitched to 15 supporting

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Further, studying consistently and maintaining good grades as a student during my time as Director-General taught me to be self-motivated, hard-working, and helped me find clever ways to be efficient in my school work, and delivery in my position. Having worked in different capacities requiring creative engagement, please find my canva portfolio [here](#).

Working at American Express will enable me to